

Philipp Hilbert. *Enterprise product owner with a DevOps spine and an Agile delivery record.*

Positioning, Product manager with 13 years in regulated industries, SAFe-fluent, and proven at shipping complex technical products inside large matrix organisations.

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§ WHY EMIRATES

Emirates IT operates at a scale few product organisations ever reach, 50+ agile teams, multinational engineering, and real-time operational pressure that leaves no room for slow feedback loops. The posting calls out PI planning, backlog governance, technical debt prioritisation, and end-to-end lifecycle accountability: that is exactly the surface I have been working on for 13 years, including a fully SAFe engagement at Scheidt & Bachmann and a workflow analytics platform for one of Germany's largest federal agencies. One signal from the description landed clearly: the expectation that a TPO not only manages the backlog but actively instruments success metrics and uses them to propose further iterations, that is continuous discovery applied inside a delivery machine, and it is how I have worked at every engagement. *That discipline, measure first, then prioritise, is where I find the most leverage.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

Aviation operations are a domain I have not worked in directly; my regulated-industry background covers defence AI, health insurance, government analytics, and fintech. The transferable mechanic is identical: complex, compliance-bound workflows with multiple stakeholder tiers, non-negotiable uptime, and delivery pressure that cannot wait for perfect information.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo refactors and spec generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, pair-coding and code review acceleration
- **Cursor / VSCode**, context-aware editing
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, structured document drafting and edge-case generation
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder presentations
- **Framer**, design-heavy prototyping

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, Helm, GitOps, Jenkins, CI/CD, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin with Spring Boot, Django, SQL, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

LIBERATION OF [BAJOR GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A self-built multi-agent coding framework.

- Orchestrates file-queue-based agent loops for autonomous code generation and review tasks.
- Built on lightweight Python agent primitives with no dependency on commercial orchestration frameworks.
- Developed in parallel with a backtesting engine and trading-bot infrastructure, providing real operational load.
- Demonstrates the hands-on technical depth a TPO needs when briefing engineering teams on agentic automation initiatives.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT EMIRATES

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow PI planning artefacts and active team backlogs, identify where acceptance criteria are vague or where technical debt has no story pointing, and build a dependency map across the agile release trains I am accountable for.

WEEK 2

Refine and align.

Run backlog refinement sessions with each team, introduce a consistent definition of done, and close the first gap between what the business expects in the next PI and what the engineering teams have capacity to deliver.

WEEK 3+

Ship and instrument.

Drive the first PI demo contribution, define the success metrics for the work shipped, and establish a rhythm of proposing data-backed BAU iterations before the next PI planning cycle opens.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Technical Product Owner position at Emirates Group IT. The role sits at exactly the intersection where I have spent the last several years: large-scale SAFe delivery organisations, technically complex backlogs with real non-functional requirements, and the expectation that a product owner does not just write stories but takes accountability for the full lifecycle, roadmap through instrumentation.

My most directly relevant engagement was at Scheidt & Bachmann Fuel & Convenience Retail, where I embedded into a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning, moving research outcomes across a matrix organisation into production. Before that, at the Bundesagentur für Arbeit, I owned a national labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers: I introduced Dagster and dbt to eliminate hand-held quarterly imports, integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline to recover QA hours, and served as Deputy IT Security Officer, which gave me a close view of how governance and delivery interact at federal scale. Both experiences taught me that the bottleneck in large programmes is rarely effort; it is clarity at the story level and honest prioritisation of technical debt before it becomes an incident.

At Rohde & Schwarz, working on an internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European defence programme, I introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD across a multinational team of architects, data scientists, and engineers. Rollout time fell from days to 30 minutes and the platform became hotfix-capable. I also pushed my way into customer workshops, instrumented two competing workflows, and redirected the product when click data showed the elegant UI option recording exactly zero engagement. That is the kind of empirical discipline the Emirates posting asks for when it talks about defining metrics, measuring success, and proposing further iterations within available capacity.

What draws me to Emirates specifically is the scale: 50+ teams means the decisions I make about acceptance criteria quality, dependency flagging, and backlog integrity have an outsized downstream effect. I find that motivating rather than daunting, the leverage is real in both directions, which sharpens the work. I am relocating to Dubai and am comfortable with full on-site engagement from day one.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background maps to your current programme priorities.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager and owner with 13 years of end-to-end accountability in regulated industries, defence AI, federal government analytics, health insurance, fintech, and B2B SaaS. I run continuous discovery, translate strategy and technical constraints into a prioritised backlog, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery at scale. In SAFe environments I operate at the team PO level, contributing to PI planning, managing dependencies across release trains, and instrumenting success metrics that drive the next iteration.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning, backlog refinement, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog prioritisation, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, MVP and PoC definition, A/B testing, user research, prototyping, product lifecycle management.

Analytics and Data: KPI definition, funnel and churn analysis, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, Django, SQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder alignment, cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI / DATA PLATFORM 2024 TO 2025

Introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD across a multinational team; rollout time fell to 30 minutes and the platform became hotfix-capable. Instrumented competing workflows; redirected product to developer-code-first design based on zero-click evidence from the UI-led alternative.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023 TO 2024

Introduced Dagster and dbt to automate quarterly imports; integrated test automation into Jenkins pipeline; migrated bare-metal system to containers. Deputy IT Security Officer. Carried full UI relaunch in parallel.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE 2023

Cut roadmap to top 10% of features; user acceptance rose more than fivefold. Implemented CGM KIS interface personally: digital anamnesis time fell from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production, cutting time-to-market from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL AND
PAYMENTS 2021 TO 2022

Moved research results into production in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning across a matrix organisation.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · INTERIM PRODUCT OWNER · GOVERNMENT / SECURE
DATA 2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PROXY PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE /
PROCUREMENT 2019 TO 2020

Migrated legacy B2B procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and approximately 20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY / SITE IT 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE / CLINICAL
NETWORK 2017 TO 2018

WLAN rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION
STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025 TO 2026

Zero to one: two-sided B2B marketplace with anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE
ENCRYPTION 2016 TO 2021

Shipped three-layer hardware-software product installing in under two minutes. Later Chair of the Board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · AGRITECH
2018 TO 2021

Laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH / P2P
PAYMENTS 2013 TO 2018

Built from zero to acquisition; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · EMIRATES

